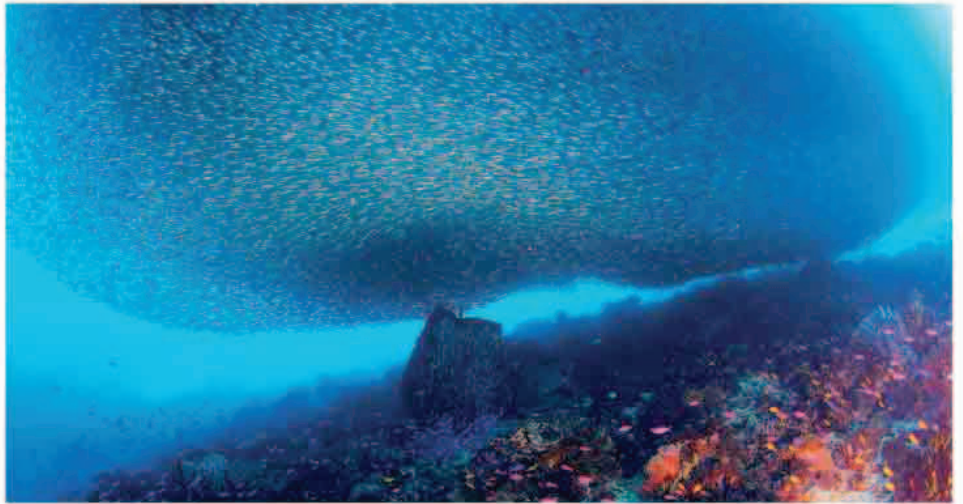


WOW!

Before they were affected by overfishing, some schools of Atlantic herring contained a billion fish or more, and were 1 mile (1.6 km) across.



SCHOOL DISCIPLINE

Many fish swim in formation—a type of behavior known as schooling. They align themselves by watching each other, using visual clues such as brightly colored markings and patterns. They can also sense the pressure waves in the water generated by the movement of their neighbors. This helps them stay spaced out in perfect formation when they change direction.

SUPERORGANISM

Fish that swim in big schools often move together in such perfect harmony that they are like one giant animal—a superorganism. Swimming in such tight formation gives their prey very little chance of escaping.

▼ COLOR-CODED CLUES

The vivid yellow tails of these fusiliers flash instant signals to the rest of the school, enabling all the fish to switch direction at the same time.

